

in. The HKCU key is a link to the HKEY_USERS subkey that belongs to the user; both places have the identical information. Each user's settings are stored in their own NTUSER.DAT and USRCLASS.DAT files under their own Documents and Settings subdirectory on Windows NT-based systems (or their own Users sub folder in Windows Vista and Windows 7). This hive's settings are carried across from machine to machine by users with a roaming profile.

HKEY_PERFORMANCE_DATA

This key enables access to performance data provided by the NT kernel or by operating system drivers, programmes, and services that offer performance statistics. This key is not stored in any hive and is not visible in the Registry Editor, but it can be accessed via the Windows API registry functions, or in a simplified view via the Task Manager's Performance tab (for a limited set of performance data on the local system), or via more advanced control panels (such as the Performances Monitor or the Performances Analyzer which allows collecting and logging these data, including from remote systems).

HKEY_DYN_DATA

Only Windows 95, Windows 98, and Windows Me supported this key. It includes Plug & Play and network performance statistics, as well as information about hardware devices. The data in this hive isn't saved on the hard drive either. At launch, the Plug and Play information is gathered and configured, then saved in memory.

Values

Name/data pairs are kept as registry values in keys. The terms registry values and registry keys are not interchangeable. In a registry key, each registry value has its own name, regardless of letter case. The Windows API functions that query and update registry information isolate the value names from the key path and/or handle that identifies the parent key. Registry variables with backslashes in their names make it harder to distinguish them from their key paths when using numerous legacy Windows Registry API actions (whose usage is deprecated in Win32).

Although each registry key is similar to an associative array, the name portion of each registry value is referred to as a "key" in standard parlance. The phrases are a relic from the 16-bit registry of Windows 3, which permitted registry keys to have only one unnamed value rather than arbitrary